

Document 1

. . . When the United States won its independence from Great Britain in 1783, one of its major concerns was having a European power on its western boundary, and the need for unrestricted access to the Mississippi River. As American settlers pushed west, they found that the Appalachian Mountains provided a barrier to shipping goods eastward. The easiest way to ship produce was to build a flatboat and float down the Ohio and Mississippi Rivers to the port of New Orleans, from which goods could be put on ocean-going vessels. The problem with this route was that the Spanish owned both sides of the Mississippi below Natchez.

In 1795 the United States negotiated the Pinckney Treaty with Spain, which provided the right of navigation on the river and the right of deposit [right to store goods until export] of U.S. goods at the port of New Orleans. . . . Spain was eager to divest [relieve] itself of Louisiana, which was a drain on its financial resources. On October 1, 1800, Napoleon Bonaparte, First Consul of France, concluded the Treaty of San Ildefonso with Spain, which returned Louisiana to French ownership in exchange for a Spanish kingdom in Italy. . . .

Source: "The Louisiana Purchase," *Museum Gazette*, National Park Service, December 1991 (adapted)

31 Based on this document, what is *one* historical circumstance that led to the purchase of the Louisiana Territory?

Score of 1:

- States a historical circumstance that led to the purchase of the Louisiana Territory, based on this document

Examples: major concern of United States after winning independence was having a European power on western boundary/need for unrestricted access to Mississippi River; Appalachian Mountains provided barrier to shipping goods eastward; easiest way for western settlers to ship produce was to use Ohio and Mississippi Rivers to get to port of New Orleans; goods could be put on ocean-going vessels in New Orleans; Spain owned both sides of Mississippi River below Natchez; Pinckney Treaty with Spain in 1795 provided right of navigation on Mississippi River/right of deposit at port of New Orleans; Louisiana returned to French ownership in Treaty of San Ildefonso in 1800

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response

Examples: United States won independence from Great Britain in 1783; Appalachian Mountains provided easy route for western settlers to ship goods eastward; Pinckney Treaty negotiated with France/Napoleon; Louisiana was returned to Spanish ownership in 1800

- Vague response

Examples: build a flatboat; Napoleon Bonaparte was First Consul of France; exchanged for a Spanish kingdom in Italy; negotiations; the U.S. wanted more

- No response

Document 2

. . . Jefferson asked James Monroe, a former member of Congress and former governor of Virginia, to join [Robert R.] Livingston in Paris as minister extraordinary with discretionary powers to spend \$9,375,000 to secure New Orleans and parts of the Floridas (to consolidate the U.S. position in the southeastern part of the continent). . . .

By the time Monroe arrived in Paris on April 12, the situation had, unknown to him, radically altered: Napoléon had suddenly decided to sell the entire Louisiana Territory to the United States. He had always seen Saint Domingue, with a population of more than 500,000, producing enough sugar, coffee, indigo, cotton and cocoa to fill some 700 ships a year, as France's most important holding in the Western Hemisphere. The Louisiana Territory, in Napoléon's view, was useful mainly as a granary for Saint Domingue. With the colony in danger of being lost, the territory was less useful. Then, too, Napoléon was gearing up for another campaign against Britain and needed funds for that. . . .

Source: Joseph A. Harriss, "How the Louisiana Purchase Changed the World," *Smithsonian*, April 2003 (adapted)

32 According to Joseph A. Harriss, what is *one* historical circumstance that led to the purchase of the Louisiana Territory?

Score of 1:

- States a historical circumstance that led to the purchase of the Louisiana Territory, according to Joseph A. Harriss

Examples: Jefferson asked James Monroe and Robert Livingston to spend \$9,375,000 to secure New Orleans and parts of the Floridas/consolidate United States position in southeastern part of continent; Napoleon decided to sell entire Louisiana Territory to United States; Louisiana was less useful to Napoleon as Saint-Domingue was in danger of being lost; Napoleon needed money as he was gearing up for another campaign against Britain

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: Saint-Domingue most important French holding in Western Hemisphere; Saint-Domingue produced sugar/coffee/indigo/cotton/cocoa; Napoleon decided to keep Louisiana Territory; Saint-Domingue used mainly as granary for Louisiana; Britain needed money to fight Napoleon; Livingston was minister to Paris
- Vague response
Examples: discretionary powers; situation radically altered; Monroe arrived in Paris; things would be better for the United States
- No response

Document 3

... While the deal [Napoleon's offer to sell the entire Louisiana Territory] was instantly popular, there were problems. Negotiations would need to start with Great Britain and Spain about shared boundaries. And there was a debate about whether and how such a large property purchase was allowed under the Constitution.

Jefferson took a strict, literal view of constitutional powers, meaning that specific powers reserved for the President and Executive Branch needed to be spelled out in the Constitution. The ability to buy property from foreign governments was not among these powers listed [in] the Constitution. . . .

Instead, Jefferson considered a constitutional amendment the only way to conclude the deal with France. "The General Government has no powers but such as the Constitution gives it," he wrote to John Dickinson in 1803. "It has not given it power of holding foreign territory, and still less of incorporating it into the Union. An amendment of the Constitution seems necessary for this." . . .

Jefferson's cabinet, including James Madison, disagreed about the need for a constitutional amendment. The President also had been assured earlier in the year by Albert Gallatin, his Treasury Secretary, that any potential deal with France would be permissible and implied under the Constitution's treaty-making provisions. . . .

The debate in the Senate only lasted for two days. On October 20, 1803, the Senate voted for ratification 24-7, and the treaty was signed on October 31, 1803. . . .

Source: "The Louisiana Purchase: Jefferson's Constitutional Gamble," *Constitution Daily*, National Constitution Center (adapted)

33 Based on this document, state *one* way the constitutional issue raised by the Louisiana Purchase was addressed.

Score of 1:

- States a way the constitutional issue raised by the Louisiana Purchase was addressed, based on this document

Examples: debate about whether/how such large property purchase would, be allowed under Constitution; Jefferson believed he should use strict/literal view of constitutional powers since specific powers reserved for president and executive branch needed to be spelled out in Constitution; Jefferson considered a constitutional amendment only way to conclude deal with France; Jefferson assured by Treasury Secretary Albert Gallatin that any potential deal with France would be permissible and implied under Constitution's treaty-making provision; Senate debated for two days; discussion between president and cabinet members

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: Napoleon's offer instantly popular; negotiations ended with Great Britain and Spain; amendment added to Constitution; Senate voted against ratification of treaty; Senate debated for one day
- Vague response
Examples: there were efforts; large property purchase; General Government no powers; incorporating everything into Union; Jefferson's cabinet couldn't decide
- No response

Document 4

. . . While Jefferson and his followers were altering their political philosophy to accommodate Louisiana, the Federalists of New England, led by [Timothy] Pickering, were also doing an about-face, from broad to strict interpretation of the Constitution. In this way, they hoped to prevent the inclusion of Louisiana in the Union. . . .

Standing alone, New England Federalism began to attack the Louisiana Purchase on various grounds. . . . Much attention was given to the huge sum that was to be paid for this desolate wilderness. . . . There was concern among some that the French title to Louisiana was not clear and that an attempt to occupy this region would involve the United States in a war with Spain, from whom France had obtained Louisiana. Other voices of New England Federalism urged that the purchase was unconstitutional, that the general government did not have the power to acquire foreign territory. . . .

When Jefferson called a special session of Congress in October, 1803, to consider the Louisiana treaty, Pickering and his fellow Federalists in Congress proceeded to Washington with much determination to defeat the agreement. Their attack was to be launched on constitutional grounds. . . .

Source: Thomas J. Farnham, "The Federal-State Issue and the Louisiana Purchase," *Louisiana History: The Journal of the Louisiana Historical Association*, 1965 (adapted)

34 According to Thomas J. Farnham, what is *one* effort by Federalists to oppose the Louisiana Purchase?

Score of 1:

- States an effort by Federalists to oppose the Louisiana Purchase, according to Thomas J. Farnham

Examples: Federalists and Pickering changed from broad to strict interpretation of Constitution; attacked huge sum being paid for desolate wilderness; expressed concern that French title to Louisiana not clear and attempt to occupy region would involve United States in war with Spain; urged that purchase was unconstitutional/general government did not have power to acquire foreign territory; went to special session of Congress determined to defeat Louisiana treaty on constitutional grounds; Federalists attacked on constitutional grounds

Score of 0:

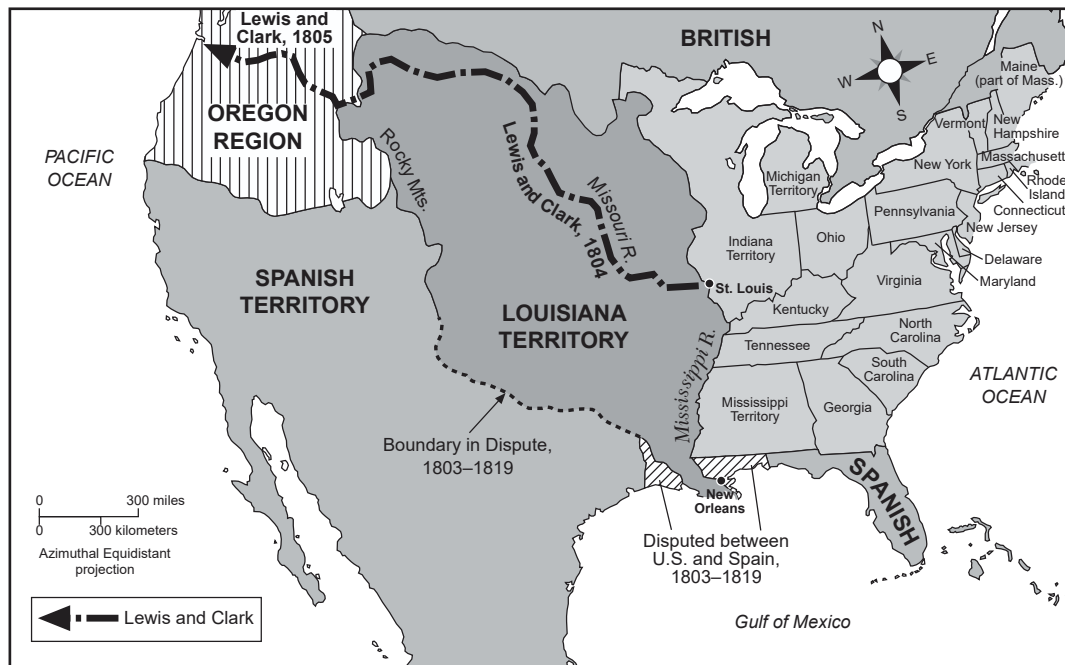
- Incorrect response

Examples: changed from strict to broad interpretation of Constitution; expressed concern that attempt to occupy would involve United States in war with Great Britain; refused to attend special session of Congress called by Jefferson; France obtained Louisiana from Spain
- Vague response

Examples: Timothy Pickering; about-face; stood alone; concern among some; voices of New England Federalism; they met to change things
- No response

Document 5a

The Louisiana Purchase and Western Exploration



Source: Joyce Appleby et al., *The American Journey*, Glencoe McGraw-Hill, 2003 (adapted)

Document 5b

. . . Most people had a mental picture of what a normal country size should be. They were accustomed to smaller ones, as in Europe. The United States suddenly seemed in danger of becoming clumsily huge, as a giant would appear among men. Nearly nine hundred thousand square miles of almost virgin territory was emptiness indeed, and at first, it had seemed to fill hardly at all. Most of it was still a wilderness, largely uninhabited and not yet demanding much governance; this was not an immediate concern, only a fear for the future. But for a time, the fear was shared by many Americans. . . .

The enormous expanse to the north and west of New Orleans, the key city that had been the primary object of the Louisiana Purchase, meant that thirteen new states would eventually be created, in whole or in substantial part, from the eight hundred seventy-five thousand square miles that had been bought. These, ascending from the Gulf of Mexico to the Canadian border, are Louisiana, Arkansas, Oklahoma, Missouri, Kansas, Iowa, Nebraska, Minnesota, South Dakota, North Dakota, Colorado, Wyoming, and Montana. Their movement into statehood would take most of the nineteenth century, but during that period, there was little question that the people of the east were part of the process. Even those who never planned a trip to the west coast thought of it as part of their country, and most would have fought to defend it. . . .

Source: Charles A. Cerami, *Jefferson's Great Gamble*, Sourcebooks, 2003 (adapted)

35 Based on these documents, what is *one* impact of the Louisiana Purchase on the United States?

Score of 1:

- States an impact of the Louisiana Purchase on the United States, based on these documents
Examples: doubled size of United States/changed size of United States; part of southern boundary disputed with Spain; gave United States the port of New Orleans; many Americans feared it was too big/still wilderness/largely uninhabited; nearly nine hundred thousand square miles of virgin territory; it gave United States land between Canada and Gulf of Mexico; it would mean 13 new states eventually created (Louisiana; Arkansas; Oklahoma; Missouri; Kansas; Iowa; Nebraska; Minnesota; South Dakota; North Dakota; Colorado; Wyoming; Montana); most people thought of it as part of their country; most would fight to defend it; it led to boundary disputes with Spanish; it extended United States from Ohio River west to Rocky Mountains; Lewis and Clark expedition explored lands west of Mississippi River; exploration of northern part of Louisiana territory

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: it went to Pacific Ocean; caused problems with France; gave United States more land on Atlantic; totally uninhabited
- Vague response
Examples: Spain owned Florida; provided mental picture; clumsily huge; took much of 19th century
- No response

Document 6

Many historians have written about the Louisiana Purchase and its impact.

The Louisiana Territory was the great unknown. There were fewer facts [than] fantasy about it. What was clear at the time of the Louisiana Purchase was that it had put America on the road to becoming a truly continental power. . . .

Historian Henry Adams wrote: “The annexation of Louisiana was an event so portentous [considerable] as to defy measurement; it gave a new face to politics, and ranked in historical importance next to the Declaration of Independence and the adoption of the Constitution—events of which it was the logical outcome; but as a matter of diplomacy it was unparalleled, because it cost almost nothing.” The Louisiana Purchase changed America’s shape and destiny—but also affected international relations. . . .

Although the Louisiana Purchase provided the structure for the nation’s expansion, it also provided the seeds for its potential destruction. Historian Sean Wilentz wrote: “Over the coming decades, the consequences of the Purchase would indeed disturb public opinion over constitutional issues connected to the expansion of slavery—and help rip the country to pieces.” . . .

Source: “The Louisiana Purchase: Aftermath,” The Lehrman Institute online (adapted)

36 Based on this document, state *one* impact of the Louisiana Purchase on the United States.

Score of 1:

- States an impact of the Louisiana Purchase on the United States, based on this document
Examples: put America on road to becoming continental power; according to historian Henry Adams it gave new face to politics and ranked in historical importance next to Declaration of Independence/adoption of Constitution; as matter of diplomacy was unparalleled; changed America’s shape/destiny; affected international relations; provided structure for nation’s expansion; provided seeds for potential destruction of United States; divided public opinion over constitutional issues connected to expansion of slavery; provided seeds for Civil War

Score of 0:

- Incorrect response
Examples: led to adoption of Constitution; destroyed international relations; unified public opinion over constitutional issues; stopped nation’s expansion
- Vague response
Examples: portentous event; put America on a road; provided seeds; had consequences; it was connected; logical outcome; made things better/made things worse
- No response